

Robot that walks like a human

A bipedal robot can now walk using a heel-toe motion that copies human locomotion more closely than flat-footed robot walkers can. By rocking its feet forward from the heel and pushing off at the toe, DURUS robot imitates the walking motion of people, making it more energy-efficient and better at navigating uneven terrain, according to Christian Hubicki, postdoctoral fellow in robotics at Georgia Institute of Technology and one of the researchers who helped DURUS walk.

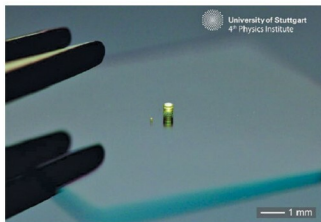
The humanoid robot DURUS was designed collaboratively by the research non-profit SRI International and Georgia Tech's Advanced Mechanical Bipedal Experimental Robotics (AMBER) Lab. An earlier DURUS design was modified to accommodate the new manner of walking, enabled by a novel mathematical algorithm that adjusts the robot's momentum and balance, one step at a time.



DURUS, the Robo-Walker (Image courtesy: www.news.gatech.edu)

Tiny camera that can be injected into the brain

Researchers at University of Stuttgart, Germany, have developed a tiny camera that could be used in medicine, security monitoring and for miniature robots. They have used 3D-printing methods to build the camera's three lenses layer-by-layer. This technique represents a paradigm shift in the



The compound lens is just 100 micrometres (0.1 millimetres or 0.004 inches) wide, and 120 micrometres with its casing (Image courtesy: www.phys.org)

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